SET-UP: • Place the **Theatre** cards in a row, in a random order.
Players will play cards 'into' Theatres in columns on their side of this row.
• Randomly deal the **Supreme Commander Cards,** this decides first player.
• Deal 6 **Cards** to each player. Set the rest of the deck aside, facedown.

The Game is fought over a series of **Battles**. During a **Battle** players take **Turns** playing cards into the **Theatres** until one of them **Withdraws** or neither of them has any cards left. Their goal is to **Control** the majority of the **Theatres** by the end of the **Battle** or force their opponent to **Withdraw**.

Each **Card** has a **Theatre**, an **Ability** and a **Strength** value.

At the end of the **Battle** the player with the highest total **Strength** on their side of a **Theatre Controls** it. If it's empty or there's a tie, 1st player **Controls.**

END OF BATTLE:

IF WITHDRAW: Winner earns points noted on loser's **Supreme Commander Card.**
OTHERWISE: Player controlling at least 2 **Theatres** wins **Battle** & gets 6 points.
VICTORY CHECK: If either player has at least **12 points** they win the game.
OTHERWISE: The game continues
• Rotate the positions of the **Theatre** cards, i.e. 1st to 2nd, 2nd to 3rd, 3rd to 1st.
• Players swap **Supreme Commander cards.**
• Shuffle all the other **Cards**, deal as above & start a new **Battle.**

DURING A BATTLE

EACH TURN: Play one card **Faceup** or **Facedown**, or **Withdraw.**

PLAY: Place a card from your hand into a **Theatre** on your side.
If **Faceup,** it must be played into a matching **Theatre**.
If **Facedown,** play it to any **Theatre**.
It must overlap any previously played cards, leaving just their abilities visible.
Then, if played **Faceup**, its **Ability** takes effect.

WITHDRAW: End the **Battle** early to deny your opponent the full points from the **Battle**. The earlier you **withdraw**, the fewer points they win.

ABILITY KEY TERMS

INSTANT: Takes effect once, when the card is **Played** or **Flipped Faceup**
∞ **ONGOING:** Always in effect while the card is **Faceup.**

FLIP a **Faceup** card **Facedown** or a **Facedown** card **Faceup**.
MOVE a card to a different **Theatre,** but on the same side. It overlaps any cards already there.
DESTROY: immediately place the card face down on the bottom of the **Deck**.

Overlapped cards are **Covered,** cards not overlapped are **Uncovered.**

NOTE:

'**You**' in card **Abilities** refers to the player whose side the card is on.

Once an **Instant Ability** begins taking effect, it always resolves fully, even if it gets flipped **Facedown** before completing.

If several **Instant Abilities** trigger around the same time, resolve them in the order that they were triggered. Resolve each fully before resolving the next.

If a card is **Destroyed** immediately after being **Played,** ignore its **Ability**.

A card can be **Played** even if its **Ability** cannot be completed.

If an **Ability** contradicts the Rules, the **Ability** takes precedence.

VARIANTS:

BEGINNER: First to win 3 battles wins the game. Don't use points or **Withdraw.**

LONG GAME: Play to 18 Points instead of 12.

DESIGNER SUGGESTED: **Transport** can only **Move Uncovered Cards**.

CLARIFICATIONS

Unless stated otherwise:

A player can **Flip** any card, including their opponent's.

An **Ability** can affect both **Covered** & **Uncovered** cards.

'**Theatre**' includes both players' sides of a **Theatre**.

Move is not the same as **Play,** it is not affected by abilities that say **Play.**

Abilities triggered by '**Play**' take effect whether a card was played as part of a player's turn or the result of an **Ability**.

You don't draw any new cards during a **Battle** (except with **Reinforce**).

If a card with an **Instant Ability** is **Flipped Facedown** its **Ability** takes effect again if it is **Flipped** back **Faceup**.

AIR DROP: If **Flipped Facedown** before its **Ability** is used the player still gets to play their next card to a non-matching theatre.

CONTAINMENT: is not triggered by a **Flipped** or **Moved** card.

COVER FIRE: Covered Cards with a **Strength** of 5 or more are reduced to 4.

DISRUPT'S Ability can **Flip** itself.

REINFORCE: **Containment** and **Blockade's Abilities** are triggered by **Reinforce**.

If you are using **First Edition Cards** with the **Revised Edition Rules:** note the following **CLARIFICATIONS** and **DIFFERENCES**:

BLOCKADE: Applies if any player plays a card in an adjacent theatre.

AMBUSH, DISRUPT AND MANOEUVRE only apply to **Uncovered Cards**.

AIR DROP: Affects next time you play a card, whether or not that's during your next turn.

DISRUPT: You flip first, then your opponent.

CONTAINMENT: Discard is the same as **Destroy.**

REINFORCE:'Draw 1 card and play it facedown to an adjacent theatre.'

REDEPLOY:'You may return 1 of your facedown cards to you hand, if you do, play a card.'

AIR

LAND

SEA